

OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in:

Art, Craft and Design (H600)

Art and Design: Fine Art (H601)

Art and Design: Graphic Communication (H602)

Art and Design: Photography (H603)

Art and Design: Textile Design (H604)

Art and Design: Three-Dimensional Design
(H605)

Art and Design: Critical and Contextual Studies
(H606)

Specification

Version 1: First Assessment 2017

This draft qualification has not yet been accredited by Ofqual. It is published to enable teachers to have early sight of our proposed approach to A Level in Art and Design. Further changes may be required and no assurance can be given at this time that the proposed qualification will be made available in its current form, or that it will be accredited in time for first teaching in 2015 and first award in 2017.

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1 Why choose an OCR A Level in Art and Design?

1a. Why choose an OCR qualification?

Choose OCR and you've got the reassurance that you're working with one of the UK's leading exam boards. Our new A Level in Art and Design courses have been developed in consultation with teachers, employers and Higher Education to provide students with a qualification that's relevant to them and meets their needs.

We're part of the Cambridge Assessment Group, Europe's largest assessment agency and a department of the University of Cambridge. Cambridge Assessment plays a leading role in developing and delivering assessments throughout the world, operating in over 150 countries.

We work with a range of education providers, including schools, colleges, workplaces and other institutions in both the public and private sectors. Over 13,000 centres choose our A levels, GCSEs and vocational qualifications including Cambridge Nationals, Cambridge Technicals and Cambridge Progression.

Our Specifications

We believe in developing specifications that help you bring the subject to life and inspire your students to achieve more.

We've created teacher-friendly specifications based on extensive research and engagement with the teaching community. They're designed to be straightforward and accessible so that you can tailor the delivery of the course to suit your needs. We aim to

encourage learners to become responsible for their own learning, confident in discussing ideas, innovative and engaged.

We provide a range of support services designed to help you at every stage, from preparation through to the delivery of our specifications. This includes:

- A wide range of high-quality creative resources including:
 - o Delivery Guides
 - o Transition Guides
 - o Topic Exploration Packs
 - o Lesson Elements
 - o ...and much more.
- Access to subject specialists to support you through the transition and throughout the lifetime of the specifications.
- CPD/Training for teachers including face-to-face events to introduce the qualifications and prepare you for first teaching.
- Active Results – our free results analysis service to help you review the performance of individual students or whole schools.
- ExamCreator – our new online past papers service that enables you to build your own test papers from past OCR exam questions.

All A level qualifications offered by OCR are accredited by Ofqual, the Regulator for qualifications offered in England.

1b. Why choose an OCR A Level in Art and Design?

This specification builds on the knowledge, skills and understanding established by the National Curriculum for Art and Design and is designed to contribute to the quality, breadth of choice and coherence of national provision.

It is designed to encourage learners to develop skills, creativity, imagination and independence based on personal experience, taught skills and critical understanding. Learners show this through their responses to a range of stimuli.

It provides an opportunity for learners to take a personal interest in why Art and Design matters and to be inspired and changed by studying a coherent, worthwhile course of study and gain experience of the working practices of individuals, organisations and creative and cultural industries.

It offers a 'framework' approach whereby centres can design and develop courses appropriate to their own learners and broad enough in design to allow flexibility in terms of delivery.

It provides freedom for learners to experiment and take risks with their work whilst developing their own style.

This Art and Design suite offers seven specialisms (endorsed titles) to choose from. These cover the depth and breadth of Art and Design including the use of traditional and digital production methods.

The OCR A Level in Art and Design is designed to allow centres to manage the diversity of different skills, knowledge and understanding required within the specialisms and areas of study.

Aims and learning outcomes

The aims and learning outcomes for these qualifications are to enable learners to develop:

- intellectual, imaginative, creative and intuitive capabilities
- investigative, analytical, experimental, practical, technical and expressive skills, aesthetic understanding and critical judgement
- independence of mind in developing, refining and communicating their own ideas, their own intentions and their own personal outcomes
- an interest in, enthusiasm for, and enjoyment of art, craft and design
- the experience of working with a broad range of media
- an understanding of the interrelationships between art, craft and design processes and an awareness of the contexts in which they operate
- knowledge and experience of real world contexts and, where appropriate, links to the creative industries
- knowledge and understanding of art, craft, design and media and technologies in contemporary and past societies and cultures
- an awareness of different roles, functions, audiences and consumers of art, craft and design.

These qualifications offer learners an opportunity to fully develop and explore their chosen specialism(s) whilst expanding their knowledge, understanding and skills in a range of specialist areas.

Learners will develop a deep understanding of their chosen specialism and the ability to critically evaluate their own work and the work of others. Learners are able to tailor their course to fit their individual needs, choices and aspirations in order to follow their chosen progression route through to Further or Higher Education or the workplace.

1c. What are the key features of this specification suite?

- There is a choice of seven specialisms (endorsed titles) to choose from. Each is made up of two components: a Personal investigation (60%) and an Externally set task (40%).
- The Personal investigation has two integrated elements: a portfolio of practical work and a related study which explores the context in which their chosen practical area of study exists.
- This qualification provides clear marking criteria common to both the Personal investigation practical work and the Externally set task for all specialisms, in order to aid consistent application across components.
- This qualification provides clear distinct assessment criteria for the related study as part of the Personal investigation marking criteria.
- This qualification offers assessment which is all internally marked and externally moderated by visit.
- There is a choice of themes for the Externally set task, which are open to all specialisms. Each theme offers a choice of textual and visual starting points, briefs and stimuli.
- There is maximum flexibility in delivery: the theme and starting point for the Personal investigation is set by the teacher and learner and there is no set time restriction on preparation periods for the Externally set task.
- Learners may work entirely in non-digital media or entirely in digital media, or a combination of both.
- OCR's A Level in Art and Design is fully co-teachable with OCR's one component AS level qualification.

1d. How do I find out more information?

If you are already using OCR specifications you can contact us at: www.ocr.org.uk

If you are not already a registered OCR centre then you can find out more information on the benefits of becoming one at: www.ocr.org.uk

Find out more?

Ask a subject expert:

Email: ocr.artsandmedia@ocr.org.uk

Customer Contact Centre: 01223 553998

Teacher support: www.ocr.org.uk

News: www.ocr.org.uk

2 The specification overview

2a. Overview of A Level in Art and Design (H600-H606)

Learners must complete both components (01 and 02) to be awarded the A Level in Art and Design.

Content Overview	Assessment Overview	
There are seven qualifications available for study. The available specialisms are: • Art, Craft and Design (H600) • Fine Art (H601) • Graphic Communication (H602) • Photography (H603) • Textile Design (H604) • Three-Dimensional Design (H605) • Critical and Contextual Studies (H606) Component 01: Personal investigation • Learners should produce two elements: (i) a portfolio of practical work showing their personal response to either a starting point, brief, scenario or stimulus, devised and provided by the learner or centre (ii) a related study: an extended response of a guided minimum of 1000 words. Component 02: Externally set task • The early release paper will be issued on 1 February and will provide learners with a number of themes, each with a range of written and visual starting points, briefs and stimuli. • A response should be based on one of these options.	Personal investigation (01) 120 marks non exam assessment (internally assessed and externally moderated)	60% of total A level
	Externally set task (02) 80 marks 15 hours non exam assessment (internally assessed and externally moderated)	40% of total A level

2b. Content of A Level Art and Design (H600-H606)

Component 01: Personal investigation

This component comprises two discrete but linked elements.

Element 1: Practical portfolio

This is a practical portfolio with supporting contextual research in which learners are expected to develop a personal response based on the centre-set or learner-set theme leading to a finished realisation(s) or outcome(s).

This portfolio will consist of a sustained project, theme or course of study. It may be presented in appropriate formats for the specialism and area of study chosen using, for example, sketchbooks, mounted sheets, maquettes, prototypes, digital presentations, animation, scale models or illustrated written work.

There is no restriction on the scale of work produced or the timeframe for undertaking the work but learners should carefully **select**, **organise** and **present** work to ensure that they provide evidence of meeting all four assessment objectives.

Learners must show they have:

- independently developed ideas through sustained and focused investigations in response to a given starting point
- produced material informed by contextual and other sources that informs the development of their practical work

- explored ideas, techniques or processes appropriate to their chosen specialism(s)
- recorded observations from sources relevant to intentions
- critically reviewed and refined their work as it progresses
- used their planning and preparation to produce coherent realisation(s)/outcome(s).

For the purposes of assessment, learners will provide evidence of all the assessment objectives through the **careful selection and presentation** of their work. The practical portfolio should be viewed as a whole and judgements regarding the extent to which all of the assessment objectives have been met should be made across the submission as a whole.

OCR-produced exemplar material is provided to help centres design and set their own starting points, briefs, scenarios and stimuli but this material must not be used for summative assessment. This is available on the [OCR website](#).

Element 2: Related study

Learners are required to establish through this written and, where appropriate, illustrated component, the related context in which their chosen practical portfolio exists.

This may be established by exploring the genre, subject matter, movement or historical framework of the overarching starting point, course of study or theme selected.

The aim of the related study is to enable learners to develop their ability to communicate their knowledge and understanding of art historical movements, genres, practitioners and artworks, considering the way that these change and evolve within chronological and other frameworks. It also builds their understanding of the relationship between society and art: art historical terms, concepts and issues; methods of researching, investigating and analysing; and how works are interpreted and evaluated.

The related study should be separate and clearly identifiable from the contextual research embedded in the development of the practical portfolio. Learners should also highlight their own work and clearly distinguish it from collected or transposed material.

Learners may produce the related study in an appropriate form of which the following are some examples: an illustrated essay, digital presentation/blog, illustrated study sheets or written report.

It is a requirement of the related study that all source material and research are listed and acknowledged in a bibliography and should be clearly identifiable in the work presented for assessment.

The two elements of the Personal investigation are marked using the relevant sections of the Personal investigation Marking Criteria in Section 3e.

Component 02: Externally set task

For this component, an early release paper will be dispatched to centres based on estimated entries made and will also be available on the [OCR website](#) from 1 February.

This paper can be given to learners at the discretion of centres any time on or after 1 February in the year of certification. Centres may determine the amount of time for preparatory study prior to learners undertaking their fifteen-hour supervised time period.

The paper will give learners a choice of seven themes, each with a choice of written and/or visual starting points, briefs or stimuli. From this paper, learners are expected to choose **one** option for which they will generate an appropriate personal response for assessment.

Please see the Specimen Assessment Material for an example of the paper.

Planning and preparation

The amount of time given to learners for the preparation period should be determined by centres. Learners must be given a preparatory period during which they will research, plan and develop ideas for their own response to the option they have chosen. During this preparatory period teachers may give limited guidance. Guidance should be given to learners about availability and choice of materials, health and safety, avoidance of plagiarism and completion of work in accordance with specification requirements and procedures. However, it should be remembered that learners are required to reach their own judgements and conclusions and must work independently to produce their own personal response.

All work must be completed by the designated finishing time set by the centre. Dates and deadlines for preparatory work and the fifteen-hour supervised time, must be set by centres in order to facilitate the completion of marking and internal standardisation by the OCR-set deadline. See Section 4: Admin: what you need to know.

Realising intentions

Learners will have up to fifteen hours in which to independently realise their response(s). The fifteen-hour supervised time can be divided into a number of sessions and timetabled to suit the centre. Centres should ensure that short sessions are avoided.

For regulations governing examinations, centres should consult the *OCR Administration Guide for General Qualifications*, or the JCQ document, *General and Vocational Qualifications: Instructions for Conducting Examinations*.

Learners are required to provide evidence of all assessment objectives in response to their chosen starting point, brief or stimulus, within the fifteen-hour supervised time period. It is expected that during the supervised time period, learners will realise their intentions to an outcome(s).

All selected work produced for the component, including the research, planning and development work produced in the preparatory period must be submitted for assessment.

The Externally set task is marked using the relevant marking criteria for the Externally set task in Section 3e.

2c. Core Content of A Level in Art and Design

The following core content outlines the scope, context, approaches, skills and knowledge and understanding which underpin all the endorsed Art and Design

titles (specialisms) within the suite of qualifications. This needs to be used in conjunction with the content provided for each specialism.

Scope and Context:	• Learners must engage in integrated critical, practical and theoretical study in Art and Design. • Learners must demonstrate an ability to work within relevant frameworks and use a broad range of media. They must develop independence in relation to exploring their own ideas and lines of enquiry, refining intentions and producing personal outcomes. • Understanding context is a significant element in the process of building knowledge of the subject. It provides the relevant platform to help explore and understand ideas, feelings and meanings. • Learners should demonstrate an understanding of the context through critical evaluation in relation to research, written analysis and practical work. Contextual referencing should be evidenced through evaluation of historical and contemporary practitioners, creative industries, societies and cultures, popular culture, historical and current events. • Learners' critical and contextual understanding will be evidenced throughout all processes and outcomes. The form of critical and contextual understanding may be directed by the approach to media used in the specialism(s) taken but not exclusively so. • Learners must demonstrate, where applicable, an awareness of different roles, functions, audiences and consumers of art, craft and design. • The related study element must extend learners' understanding and knowledge of context. Learners are required to establish, through this written and illustrated element, the overarching principles of their specialist area. This may be established by exploring art theory, genre, subject matter, movement or historical framework. • Through the course of study learners must understand the importance of the on-going development and refining process. The production of outcome(s) in the context of developing their skills and knowledge, as well as an awareness of the links between practical and written material, is necessary. • Learners are required to identify and acknowledge all sources consulted during their research which should be in the form of a bibliography of books, journals and websites.
Approaches:	• Learners should be made aware of the broad range of media and approaches in which they can operate. • Learners may work in traditional media, digital media and emerging technologies or a combination within any specialism. • Critical and contextual understanding should be embedded throughout the course of study through all investigative processes, research and practical work. Learners should reflect critically and extract meaning from art, craft and design and use this to place their own work in a framework of advanced study. Approaches to critical and contextual understanding can be modified, either as a link and support to practical work, or research into the overarching context of art, craft and design. • Learners may use a range of approaches to demonstrate progression of

	ideas relevant to their chosen specialism: these may include sketchbooks, workbooks, journals, digital and audio presentations and associated software. • Learners may take an applied approach to any specialism, working to a brief and framework whilst developing an awareness of the approaches and activities that relate to the creative industries. An applied approach should reflect the current working practices, constraints, functions, audiences, consumers and clients within the professional art and design sector. • Approaches to drawing may be different across specialisms. For example, in Fine Art, observational drawing using traditional media may be employed, whereas in textiles, stitch and fashion illustrations are commonly used.
Core Skills:	Learners are required to develop the skills to: • record experiences and observations, in a variety of ways using drawing or other appropriate visual forms; undertake research and gather, select and organise visual and other appropriate information • explore relevant resources; analyse, discuss and evaluate images, objects and artefacts; and make and record independent judgements • use knowledge and understanding of the work of others to develop and extend thinking and inform own work • generate and explore potential lines of enquiry using appropriate media and techniques • apply knowledge and understanding in making images and artefacts; review and modify work: plan and develop ideas in the light of their own and others' evaluations • organise, select and communicate ideas, solutions and responses, and present them in a range of visual and written forms.
Core Knowledge and Understanding:	Learners are required to develop practical and theoretical knowledge and understanding of: • relevant materials, processes, technologies and resources • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural contexts • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology.

2c. Summary of Specialisms and related Areas of Study

OCR Art and Design specialisms	OCR Art and Design Areas of Study
Learners select one specialism from the seven below.	Learners are required to choose one or more area(s) of study relevant to the chosen specialism.
Art, Craft and Design – combined areas of study (H600)	Learners may combine areas of study within and/or across specialisms for Art, Craft and Design. • Fine Art: painting, printmaking or sculpture • Graphic Communication: illustration, packaging or advertising • Photography: traditional, digital or moving image • Textile Design: printed and digital textiles, fashion design or constructed textiles • Three-Dimensional Design: ceramics, product design or jewellery • Critical and Contextual Studies: art theory, artistic movements or architecture
Fine Art (H601)	• Portraiture • Landscape • Still life • Human form • Abstraction • Experimental imagery • Narrative • Installation • Working in a genre
Graphic Communication (H602)	• Image and typography • Illustration • Advertising • Layout design • Packaging • Editorial design • Experimental imagery • Signage • Abstract approaches
Photography (H603)	• Portraiture • Landscape photography • Commercial photography • Still life photography • Documentary photography • Experimental imagery • Editorial photography • Photographic installation • The photographic process • Moving image • Animation

Textile Design (H604)	• Garments/Fashion • Accessories • Soft furnishings • Printed and/or dyed textiles • Constructed textiles • Textile installation • Expressive textiles • Digital textiles
Three-Dimensional Design (H605)	• Craft or commercial ceramics • Commercial sculptures or sculptural commissions • Commercial three-dimensional design, working for a client to create a three dimensional item such as an item of jewellery • Design and/or construction for television, games or film • Stage, environmental or architectural design and/or construction • Experimental three-dimensional design (construction/montage/assemblage) • Body ornament (jewellery, fashion accessories, body painting and film or TV prosthetics) • Product design and realisation • Constructions in a range of materials
Critical and Contextual Studies (H606)	• Fine art and sculpture • Design • Craft • Art theory • The human form • Landscape and natural forms • Still life and designed objects • Architecture and the built environment • Art movements, styles and genres • Curating exhibitions • Art management and art in the community • Cultural representations within art and design • Multimedia, emerging technologies and their use in art

2c(i). Content of Art, Craft and Design – Combined Specialisms (H600)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of media. • Learners in Combined Specialisms are expected to produce work from at least two areas of specialism. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • Learners may use traditional methods and/or digital techniques to produce work. • Learners should explore relevant images, artefacts and resources. • An important focus is on learners' recording through use of drawing or other media.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in two or more area(s) of specialism from those listed below. • Fine Art: such as painting, printmaking or sculpture. • Graphic Communication: such as illustration, packaging or advertising. • Photography: such as traditional, digital or moving image. • Textile Design: such as printed and digital textiles, fashion design or fabric construction. • Three-Dimensional Design: such as ceramics, product design or jewellery. • Critical and Contextual Studies: such as art theory, artistic movements or architecture. Learners may choose one area of study and produce work appropriate to two or more specialisms such as portraiture in fine art and photography. Alternatively, learners may choose different areas of study such as installation and signage from two or more specialisms and combine them in a complementary way. Techniques Learners following a Combined Specialisms course should explore techniques relevant to the chosen area(s) of study as outlined for each chosen specialism.
Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills, as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen areas of art, craft and design. In addition, learners will be required to demonstrate skills relevant to their chosen two or more specialisms in the following: • understanding and applying space, rhythm and structure such as location, production or construction techniques • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen specialism(s) • understanding and applying formal elements such as colour, line, tone, texture, shape and form

	• selecting, editing and developing ideas • using appropriate visual language and terminology appropriate to the specialism(s) • an ability to manipulate imagery such as transposition, composition and layer • using conventions and genres appropriate to the specialism(s) selected such as portraiture, landscape, studio ceramics or installation.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to their chosen specialism(s) enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to their chosen areas of specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen specialism(s) or areas of study.

2c(ii). Content of Art and Design: Fine Art (H601)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of Fine Art media. • Learners should explore relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to Fine Art. Learners may use traditional methods and/or digital techniques to produce Fine Art work. • Learners in Fine Art are expected to demonstrate specialisation in particular materials, media or processes to allow for an appropriate depth of study. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • An important focus is on learners recording through using drawing or other appropriate visual forms.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Fine Art, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible. • portraiture • landscape • still life • human form • abstraction • experimental imagery • narrative • installation • working in a genre. Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to learners in Fine Art: mark making, mixed-media, casting, glazing, collage, intaglio, photographic printing and digital manipulation.
Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Fine Art. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • understanding and the use of pictorial space and real space, composition, rhythm, scale and structure in Fine Art • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen work and direction relevant to learners' intentions • understanding and applying formal elements such as colour, line, tone, texture, shape and form in relation to Fine Art • selecting, editing and developing ideas • using appropriate visual language and terminology within Fine Art • manipulating imagery • understanding and using relevant conventions and genres in Fine Art such as figurative, abstract and symbolic.

Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area, enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Fine Art and the chosen areas of study within this specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study within Fine Art.
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2c(iii). Content of Art and Design: Graphic Communication (H602)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of media specific to Graphic Communication. • Learners should explore relevant images, text, design and resources relating to Graphic Communication. Learners may use traditional methods such as drawing, printing and/or digital techniques to produce graphic images. • Learners in Graphic Communication are expected to demonstrate specialisation in particular materials, media or processes to allow for an appropriate depth of study. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • An important focus is on learners recording through the use of image and text to create meaning.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Graphic Communication, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible. • image and typography • illustration • advertising • layout design • packaging • editorial design • experimental imagery • signage • abstract approaches. Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to learners in Graphic Communication: image editing, digital manipulation, layout, presentational and editorial techniques, printing, mark making, collage and construction.
Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Graphic Communication. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of following: • applying and using composition in Graphic Communication • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen work and direction relevant to learners' intentions • understanding and applying formal elements such as colour, tone, texture, shape and form in relation to Graphic Communication • selecting, editing and highlighting Graphic Communication imagery and text • using appropriate visual language and terminology within Graphic Communication

	- manipulating imagery - understanding and using relevant conventions and genres in Graphic Communication.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area, enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: - relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources - continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Graphic Communication and the chosen areas of study within this specialism - how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts - how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context - a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.

2c(iv). Content of Art and Design: Photography (H603)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of photographic media. • Learners should explore relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to traditional and/or digital photography. Learners may use traditional methods such as photographic film and/or digital techniques to produce images. • Learners in Photography are expected to demonstrate specialisation in particular media or processes to allow an appropriate depth of study. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • An important focus is on learners recording through using lens-based or other appropriate media.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Photography, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible. • portraiture • landscape photography • commercial photography • still-life photography • documentary photography • experimental imagery • editorial photography • photographic installation • the photographic process. • moving image • animation Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to learners in Photography: traditional darkroom technology, printing and developing films; digital technology; the use of camera equipment and lenses; lighting and exposure techniques; moving image and animation; alternative art-based printing such as screen printing; alternative chemical print processes such as liquid emulsion, toning and types of paper.
Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design core content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Photography. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • applying and using composition in Photography • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen work and direction relevant to learners' intentions • understanding and applying formal elements such as colour, tone, texture, shape and form in relation to Photography

	• selecting, editing and highlighting photographic images • using appropriate visual language and terminology within Photography • manipulating imagery • understanding and using relevant conventions and genres in Photography
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Photography and the chosen areas of study within this specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.

2c(v). Content of Art and Design: Textile Design (H604)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of textiles media. • Learners should explore relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to Textile Design. Learners may use methods such as textile design, print and digital techniques to produce outcomes in visual, tactile and/or sensory forms. • Learners in Textile Design are expected to demonstrate specialisation in particular media or processes to an appropriate depth of study. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • An important focus is on learners recording experiences and observations in stitch, textiles illustration, materials sampling and other forms.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Textile Design, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible. • garments/fashion • accessories • soft furnishings • printed and/or dyed textiles • constructed textiles • textile installation • expressive textiles • digital textiles. Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to learners in Textile Design: fabric printing, mono-printing, relief printing, screen printing, tie-dye, batik, spraying, transfer, fabric construction, stitching, appliqué, patchwork, padding, quilting, embroidery, weaving, knitting, felting and mixed-media applications.
Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Textile Design. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • recording experiences and observations, using drawing, illustration, stitch, materials or other appropriate forms • undertake research and gather, select and organise a range of appropriate materials and information • applying and using composition in textiles • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen work and direction relevant to learner intention • understanding and applying formal elements such as colour, tone, texture, shape and form in relation to Textile Design

	• using appropriate visual language and terminology within Textile Design • appreciating the relationship of form and function of textiles, such as garments, accessories and soft furnishings and, where applicable, the constraints of working to a brief • understanding and using relevant conventions and genres in Textile Design.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area, enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant research, context, technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Textile Design and the chosen areas of study within the endorsement • a range of techniques appropriate to the area of study they are working within • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.

2c(vi). Content of Art and Design: Three-Dimensional Design (H605)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and acquire techniques and develop their skills, knowledge and understanding in a range of approaches specific to Three-Dimensional Design. • Learners should explore relevant images, text, design processes and resources relating to Three-Dimensional Design. • Learners should demonstrate how they can problem solve by designing or creating products which have a decorative or functional role. They may include in their work one-off experimental pieces, traditional crafts, small batch production or industrial design for mass consumption. Learners should also demonstrate their understanding of processes. • Learners in Three-Dimensional Design are expected to demonstrate specialisation in particular media or processes to an appropriate depth of study. This can be achieved by working toward the extension and development of particular themes, ideas or issues. • An important focus is on learners recording through the use of images, models, maquettes, materials and text to create meaning.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Three-Dimensional Design, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible. • craft or commercial ceramics • commercial sculpture or sculptural commissions • commercial Three-Dimensional Design, working for a client to create a three dimensional item, such as an item of jewellery • design and/or construction for television, games or film • stage, environmental or architectural design and/or construction • experimental Three-Dimensional Design (construction/montage/assemblage) • body ornament (jewellery, fashion accessories, body painting and film or TV prosthetics) • product design and realisation • constructions in a range of materials. Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to learners in Three-Dimensional Design: drawing, modelling, casting, construction, carving, metal working, computer-aided design, welding, assemblage, laser cutting, 3D printing, ceramics and mixed-media applications.

Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Three-Dimensional Design. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • selecting and using materials either discretely or in combination, such as metal, foam board, card, glass, mosaic, ceramic, fibre and wood • understanding and application of scale appropriate to the chosen work and direction relevant to learner intention • devising spatial solutions to the various constraints presented by a product, location or environment • using appropriate visual language and terminology within Three-Dimensional Design • problem solving in three dimensions by defining role, function, material, audience and/or client relevant to the context and parameters of their work • understanding and using relevant conventions, production methods and genres in Three-Dimensional Design.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area, enabling research, exploration and the creation of the final outcome(s). Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Three-Dimensional Design and the chosen areas of study within this specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images, goods and artefacts • how images, goods and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.

2c(vii). Content of Art and Design: Critical and Contextual Studies (H606)

The content shown below must be used in conjunction with the Art and Design Core Content section.

Overview	• Learners should be able to explore, research and analyse techniques and art, craft and design practices, developing their skills, knowledge and understanding in practical and written elements specific to Critical and Contextual Study. It is anticipated that the visual and textual analysis of art, craft and design work undertaken will be the central element in this specialism. • Learners should show how they can demonstrate critical and contextual skills through researching, analysing and building understanding of one or more areas of study. An important focus is on the learner's ability to use detailed written and visual analysis when conducting research. • Learners should demonstrate evidence of research and first-hand experience of works of art, craft and/or design. • Learners must demonstrate analysis of a range of relevant works undertaken from one or more of the denoted areas of study, including supporting critical analysis using appropriate terminology. • Learners must demonstrate an integrated and relevant portfolio of practical artwork.
Areas of Study	Learners are required to work in one or more area(s) of Critical and Contextual Study, such as those listed below. Combinations of these areas are also possible: • fine art and sculpture • design • craft • art theory • the human form • landscape and natural forms • still life and designed objects • architecture and the built environment • art movements, styles and genres • curating exhibitions • art management and art in the community • cultural representations within art and design • multi-media, emerging technologies and their use in art. Techniques The following are some of the techniques available to Critical and Contextual Studies learners: extended written analysis to be accompanied by relevant visual research; collection and refinement of research taken from relevant sources; comparative analysis in the differentiation between styles, genres, subject matter and historical cultures; practical techniques as appropriate to the areas of study.

Skills	Learners will be expected to demonstrate skills as defined in the Art and Design Core Content section of this specification, in the context of their chosen area(s) of Critical and Contextual Studies. In addition learners will be required to demonstrate skills in all of the following: • selecting and using materials such as web-based research, gallery or site visits, books, journals, and other relevant resources • selecting, interpreting and scrutinising research material with the use of relevant subject terminology • understanding and using conventions when interpreting the impact/effect of social, religious and cultural contexts and local and global trends • undertaking critical analysis to ascertain and discuss appropriate historical, social and political contexts • analysing materials and techniques used by artists such as application of formal skills and construction techniques.
Knowledge and Understanding	Learners must use an appropriate range of processes and techniques using traditional and/or digital media, appropriate to the chosen subject area enabling research, exploration and the creation of final outcomes to include critical written and visual analysis. Learners will build and evidence an understanding of: • relevant technologies, materials, processes and resources • continuity and change in different genres, styles and traditions relevant to Critical and Contextual Studies and the chosen areas of study within this specialism • how ideas, feelings and meanings can be conveyed and interpreted in images and artefacts • how images and artefacts relate to the time and place in which they were made and to their social and cultural context • a working vocabulary and specialist terminology which are relevant to their chosen area(s) of study.

2d. Prior learning and progression

Learners in England who are beginning an A level course are likely to have followed a Key Stage 4 programme of study in Art and Design or equivalent.

The specification aims to support a learner's progression path. Although no prior knowledge of the subject is required, it is intended to form part of an educational continuum that progresses from Key Stages 1, 2 and 3 in the National Curriculum for Art. It will build on, but does not depend on, the knowledge, understanding and skills specified for GCSE Art and Design. It will support progression from GCE into Higher Education, further education, training or employment.

It also aims to support those learners who will study subjects or take up careers for which an art and design background is relevant or for subjects or careers where the transferable skills gained in this specification can be utilised

It may be used by teachers, employers, colleges and universities for selection purposes.

3 Assessment of OCR A Level in Art and Design

3a. Forms of assessment

Component 01: Personal investigation

Component 01 is the Personal investigation. Learners must produce two elements in response to a centre- or learner-set starting point, brief, scenario or stimulus: a portfolio of practical work and a related study.

This component is a non exam assessment. It is internally marked and externally moderated using the marking criteria in Section 3e. This component is marked out of

120 marks and contributes 60% to the overall weighting of OCR's Art and Design A Level.

The related study should consist of a guided minimum of 1000 words of extended written response.

Please refer to Section 2b of this specification for further detail.

Component 02: Externally set task

Component 02 is the Externally set task. The early release paper will be issued on **1 February** in the year of certification. It will provide learners with a range of themes each with written and visual starting points, a brief and stimuli. From these, **one** option must be selected by the learner on which they must base their personal response.

Centres will allow learners a set period of time, at their discretion, to prepare for the Externally set task timetabled fifteen-hour supervised time.

The Externally set task is a non exam assessment. It is internally marked and externally moderated using the marking criteria in Section 3e. This component is marked out of 80 marks and contributes 40% to the overall weighting of OCR's Art and Design A Level.

Please refer to Section 2b of this specification for further detail.

3b. Assessment availability

There will be:

- one examination series available each year in June to **all** learners.

This specification will be certificated from the June 2017 examination series onwards.

3c. Assessment Objectives (AO)

There are four assessment objectives in OCR's A Level in Art and Design. These are detailed in the table below.

Learners are expected to demonstrate their ability to:

	Assessment Objective
AO1	Develop ideas through sustained and focused investigations informed by contextual and other sources, demonstrating analytical and critical understanding
AO2	Explore and select appropriate resources, media, materials, techniques and processes, reviewing and refining ideas as work develops
AO3	Record ideas, observations and insights relevant to intentions, reflecting critically on work and progress
AO4	Present a personal and meaningful response that realises intentions and, where appropriate, makes connections between visual and other elements

AO weightings in A level

The relationship between the assessment objectives and the components are shown in the following table:

Component	% of A level				
	AO1	AO2	AO3	AO4	Total
Personal investigation (01)	12.5	12.5	12.5	12.5	50
Externally set task (02)	12.5	12.5	12.5	12.5	50
	25	25	25	25	100

3d. Assessment of extended responses

Within A Level in Art and Design a learner has the opportunity to demonstrate the ability to construct and develop a sustained line of reasoning through an extended response within the context of the creative process. This reflects their ability to develop, refine and record their ideas and processes, from their intention(s) through to realisation(s), whilst demonstrating their critical and contextual understanding.

The related study element within the Personal investigation provides learners with a further opportunity to demonstrate their ability to construct and develop a sustained line of reasoning and marks for any extended response are integrated into the marking criteria.

3e. Non exam assessment – Marking Criteria

All components for OCR's A Level Art and Design are internally marked and externally moderated.

Learners' work should be marked by the centre assessor to the marking criteria in the relevant table, using a 'best-fit' approach.

Marking should be positive, rewarding achievement rather than penalising failure or omissions. The awarding of marks must be directly related to the marking criteria.

Teachers should use their professional judgement in selecting band descriptors that best describe the work of the learner to place them in the appropriate band for each assessment objective strand.

To select the most appropriate mark in the band descriptor, teachers should use the following guidance:

- where the learner's work convincingly meets the statement, the highest mark should be awarded
- where the learner's work adequately meets the statement, the most appropriate mark in the middle of the range should be awarded
- where the learner's work just meets the statement, the lowest mark should be awarded.

Teachers should use the full range of marks available to them and award full marks in any band for work which fully meets that descriptor.

There should be clear evidence that work has been attempted and some work produced. If a learner submits no work for a component then the learner should be indicated as being absent from that component. If a learner completes any work at all for the component then the work should be assessed according to the marking criteria and the appropriate mark awarded, which may be zero.

For Component 01 (Personal investigation) there are two separate sets of marks to be awarded.

For the practical portfolio a mark for each Assessment Objective should be awarded out of maximum of 24 marks.

For the related study a single mark should be awarded, out of a maximum of 24 marks, using the holistic descriptors provided.

These five marks should be recorded on the Assessment Record Sheet provided and totalled to give a final mark out of a maximum of 120 for this component.

For Component 02 (Externally set task) a mark for each Assessment Objective should be awarded out of a maximum of 20 marks.

These four marks should be recorded on the Assessment Record Sheet found on the [OCR website](#), and totalled to give a final mark out of a maximum of 80 marks for this component.

OCR will provide exemplification through learner work which will help to clarify the level of achievement the internal assessors should be looking for when awarding marks.

3e. H600/01-H606/01 Personal investigation: practical portfolio and related study – Marking Criteria

Level	Element	AO1: DEVELOP	AO2: EXPLORE	AO3: RECORD	AO4: PRESENT
1	Practical portfolio	Ideas are simplistic with limited reference to contextual or other sources with evidence of uneven or unfocused investigation. Limited analysis and critical understanding. 1–4	Simple and basic exploration with limited ability to select resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Minimal evidence of review and little refinement of work as it develops. 1–4	Basic recording of ideas with limited observations showing minimal links to any deliberate intention. Evidence of reflection at a basic level and limited ability to manage progress independently. 1–4	A personal response with simplistic and basic realisation of intentions. Connections between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are limited and superficial. 1–4
	Related study	Basic ability to communicate ideas, with minimal exploration or critical and contextual understanding of ideas. Some inaccuracy and incoherence in recording when using specialist language and vocabulary are demonstrated. Simplistic knowledge and understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 1–4			
2	Practical portfolio	Ideas are developed with evidence of appropriate links to contextual or other sources with evidence of sustained investigation. Analysis and critical understanding is evident if undeveloped. 5–8	Evidence of focused exploration and of an ability to select resources, media, materials, techniques and processes competently. A review of work is evident as it develops and appropriate refinement made. 5–8	Ideas, observations and insights competently recorded to reflect intentions. Evidence of appropriate reflection on work and progress. 5–8	A personal response with some meaning and appropriate evidence of intentions realised. Connections between visual or other elements, where appropriate, are relevant. 5–8
	Related study	Some coherence when communicating ideas, with appropriate exploration and some evidence of critical and contextual understanding. Some accuracy and partially structured recording when using specialist language and vocabulary are demonstrated. Some evidence of knowledge and understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 5–8			
3	Practical portfolio	Informed ideas are developed with clear links to relevant contextual or other sources with clear evidence of sustained and focussed investigation. Detailed and effective analysis and critical understanding. 9–12	Clear exploration and ability to select relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Review shows evaluative qualities and effective refinement of work as it develops. 9–12	Effective recording of ideas, observations and insights so that links to intentions are clear. Effective reflection on work and progress. 9–12	A personal and meaningful response with clearly developed and realised links to intentions. Connections between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are appropriately developed. 9–12
	Related study	Fully coherent communication of ideas with adequate exploration and clear evidence of critical and contextual understanding. Accurate and mainly structured recording when using specialist language and vocabulary are demonstrated. Evidence of knowledge and some understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 9–12			

4	Practical portfolio	Informed ideas are well-developed, clearly reflecting influences to relevant research of contextual and other sources, with strong evidence of focused and sustained investigation. Strong, in-depth analysis and critical understanding. 13–16	Comprehensive exploration and selection of relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Thorough review and refinement of work as it develops. 13–16	Ideas and observations recorded demonstrating coherence and an insightful understanding with strong, well-developed links to intentions. Evidence of purposeful reflection on work and progress. 13–16	A personal and meaningful response with well-developed and purposeful links to intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are strong and well developed. 13–16
	Related study	Full and detailed communication of ideas with effective exploration, refinement and strong critical and contextual understanding. Strong effective use of specialist language and vocabulary in recording is demonstrated. Reasoned, in-depth knowledge and understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 13–16			
5	Practical portfolio	Informed ideas are fully developed, with intentional/deliberate reflection of influences of contextual and other sources, with strong evidence of focused and insightful sustained investigation. Demonstrates a high level of insightful analysis and critical understanding. 17–20	Full and detailed exploration and well-considered selection of relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Insightful review and refinement of work as it develops. 17–20	Ideas and observations are recorded in a way which demonstrates a high level of insightful understanding. A high level of critical evaluation and reflection on work and progress. 17–20	A personal, insightful and meaningful response with detailed and imaginative realisation of intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are insightful and fully developed. 17–20
	Related study	Excellent communication of ideas with insightful exploration, refinement and excellent critical and contextual understanding. Extensive and effective use of specialist language and vocabulary in recording is demonstrated. A high level of structured and reasoned knowledge and understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 17–20			
6	Practical portfolio	Informed ideas are fully and maturely developed, reflecting a sophisticated response to contextual and other sources, with evidence of fully focused and sustained investigation. Demonstrates a sophisticated level of analysis and critical understanding. 21–24	Extensive and thorough exploration and informed selection of relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Sophisticated review and refinement of work as it develops. 21–24	Recording of ideas, observations and insights show sophisticated understanding. A sophisticated and highly critical level of reflection on work and progress is evident. 21–24	A personal, insightful and meaningful response showing sophisticated realisation of intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are fully developed in a sophisticated manner. 21–24
	Related study	Sophisticated and sustained communication of ideas with thorough exploration, refinement and excellent critical and contextual understanding. Extensive and sophisticated handling of specialist language and vocabulary in recording is demonstrated. An accomplished level of structured and reasoned knowledge and understanding is shown when presenting the study and realising intentions. 21–24			

0 marks = no response or no response worthy of credit.

3e. H600/02-H606/02 Externally set task – Marking Criteria

LEVEL	AO1: DEVELOP	AO2: EXPLORE	AO3: RECORD	AO4: PRESENT
1	Ideas are simplistic with limited reference to contextual or other sources with evidence of uneven or unfocused investigation. Limited analysis and critical understanding. 1–4	Simple and basic exploration with limited ability to select resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Minimal evidence of review and little refinement of work as it develops. 1–4	Basic recording of ideas with limited observations showing minimal links to any deliberate intention. Evidence of reflection at a basic level and limited ability to manage progress independently. 1–4	A personal response with simplistic and basic realisation of intentions. Connections between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are limited and superficial. 1–4
2	Ideas are developed with evidence of appropriate links to contextual or other sources with evidence of sustained investigation. Analysis and critical understanding is evident if undeveloped. 5–7	Evidence of focused exploration and of an ability to select resources, media, materials, techniques and processes competently. A review of work is evident as it develops and appropriate refinement made. 5–7	Ideas, observations and insights competently recorded to reflect intentions. Evidence of appropriate reflection on work and progress. 5–7	A personal response with some meaning and appropriate evidence of intentions realised. Connections between visual or other elements, where appropriate, are relevant. 5–7
3	Informed ideas are developed with clear links to relevant contextual or other sources with clear evidence of sustained and focused investigation. Detailed and effective analysis and critical understanding. 8–10	Clear exploration and ability to select relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Review shows evaluative qualities and effective refinement of work as it develops. 8–10	Effective recording of ideas, observations and insights so that links to intentions are clear. Effective reflection on work and progress. 8–10	A personal and meaningful response with clearly developed and realised links to intentions. Connections between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are appropriately developed. 8–10
4	Informed ideas are well-developed, clearly reflecting influences to relevant research of contextual and other sources, with strong evidence of focused and sustained investigation. Strong, in-depth analysis and critical understanding. 11–13	Comprehensive exploration and selection of relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Thorough review and refinement of work as it develops. 11–13	Ideas and observations recorded demonstrating coherence and an insightful understanding with strong, well-developed links to intentions. Evidence of purposeful reflection on work and progress. 11–13	A personal and meaningful response with well-developed and purposeful links to intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are strong and well developed. 11–13

5	Informed ideas are fully developed, with intentional/deliberate reflection of influences of contextual and other sources, with strong evidence of focused and insightful sustained investigation. Demonstrates a high level of insightful analysis and critical understanding. 14–16	Full and detailed exploration and well-considered selection of relevant resources, media, materials techniques and processes. Insightful review and refinement of work as it develops. 14–16	Ideas and observations are recorded in ways which demonstrate a high level of insightful understanding. A high level of critical evaluation and reflection on work and progress. 14–16	A personal, insightful and meaningful response with detailed and imaginative realisation of intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are insightful and fully developed. 14–16
6	Informed ideas are fully and maturely developed, reflecting a sophisticated response to contextual and other sources, with evidence of fully focused and sustained investigation. Demonstrates a sophisticated level of analysis and critical understanding. 17–20	Extensive and thorough exploration and informed selection of relevant resources, media, materials, techniques and processes. Sophisticated review and refinement of work as it develops. 17–20	Recording of ideas, observations and insights show sophisticated understanding. A sophisticated and highly critical level of reflection on work and progress is evident. 17–20	A personal, insightful and meaningful response showing sophisticated realisation of intentions. Connections made between visual and other elements, where appropriate, are fully developed in a sophisticated manner. 17–20

0 marks = no response or no response worthy of credit.

3f. Synoptic assessment

OCR's A Level in Art and Design is designed to have a fully synoptic approach to teaching and learning, engaging the learner in an integrated critical, practical and theoretical study of Art and Design.

Throughout this course of study learners will engage with the creative process, which is spiral in nature and will allow learners to develop, explore, record and realise their intentions.

They will acquire a range of critical and contextual knowledge, understanding and skills as they review and refine work as it progresses. By its very nature this creative process provides truly synoptic learning.

Synoptic assessment tests the learners' understanding of the connections between different elements of Art and Design. It

involves the explicit drawing together of knowledge, understanding and skills of different aspects of the A level course.

The Assessment Objectives reflect the holistic creative process learners will engage in and work together in an integrated spiral approach. To this end each component targets each of the Assessment Objectives in their entirety and/or permits learners to demonstrate them in their entirety.

The scope and flexibility of the tasks and outcome choices available to learners allow learners to demonstrate their performance through differentiation by outcome across the full ability range.

The emphasis of synoptic assessment is to encourage the understanding of Art, Craft and Design as a discipline.

3g. Calculating qualification results

A learner's overall qualification grade for A Level in Art and Design will be calculated by adding together their marks from the two components taken to give their total weighted mark.

This mark will then be compared to the qualification level grade boundaries for the qualification(s) taken by the learner and for the relevant exam series to determine the learner's overall qualification grade.

4 Admin: what you need to know

The information in this section is designed to give an overview of the processes involved in administering this qualification so that you can speak to your exams officer. All of the following processes require you to submit something to OCR by a specific deadline.

More information about these processes, together with the deadlines, can be found in the *OCR Admin Guide and Entry Codes: 14–19 Qualifications*, which can be downloaded from the [OCR website](#).

4a. Pre-assessment

Estimated entries

Estimated entries are your best projection of the number of learners who will be entered for a qualification in a particular series. Estimated entries should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline. They are free and do not commit your centre in any way.

Estimated entries are particularly important for Art and Design so it is essential that these

are submitted to OCR on time. The early release paper for Component 02, the Externally set task, will be despatched to your centre on the basis of your estimated entries.

Final entries

Final entries provide OCR with detailed data for each learner, showing each assessment to be taken. It is essential that you use the correct entry code, considering the relevant entry rules.

Final entries must be submitted to OCR by the published deadlines or late entry fees will apply.

All learners taking A Level in Art and Design must be entered for one of the entry codes on the following page.

Entry code	Qualification Title	Components taken		
		Code	Titles	Assessment type
H600	Art, Craft and Design	01	Art, Craft and Design: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Art, Craft and Design: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H601	Art and Design: Fine Art	01	Fine Art: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Fine Art: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H602	Art and Design: Graphic Communication	01	Graphic Communication: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Graphic Communication: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H603	Art and Design: Photography	01	Photography: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Photography: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H604	Art and Design: Textile Design	01	Textile Design: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Textile Design: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H605	Art and Design: Three-Dimensional Design	01	Three-Dimensional Design: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Three-Dimensional Design: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated
H606	Art and Design: Critical and Contextual Studies	01	Critical and Contextual Studies: Personal investigation	Internally assessed and externally moderated
		02	Critical and Contextual Studies: Externally set task	Externally set, internally marked and externally moderated

Estimated grades

An estimated grade is the grade the centre expects a learner to achieve for a

qualification. These should be submitted to OCR by the specified deadline.

4b. Accessibility and special consideration

The GCSE qualification and subject criteria have been reviewed in order to identify any feature which could disadvantage candidates who share a protected Characteristic as defined by the Equality Act 2010. All reasonable steps have been taken to minimise any such disadvantage.

Reasonable adjustments and access arrangements allow learners with special educational needs, disabilities or temporary injuries to access the assessment and show what they know and can do, without changing the demands of the assessment. Applications

for these should be made before the examination series. Detailed information about eligibility for access arrangements can be found in the *JCQ Access Arrangements and Reasonable Adjustments*.

Special consideration is a post-assessment adjustment to marks or grades to reflect temporary injury, illness or other indisposition at the time the assessment was taken. Detailed information about eligibility for special consideration can be found in the *JCQ A guide to the special consideration process*.

4c. Non exam assessment

Regulations governing arrangements for internal assessments are contained in the *JCQ Instructions for conducting coursework*.

Authentication of learner work

Learners and centres must declare that the work is the learner's own.

Teachers must declare that the work submitted for internal assessment is the

learner's own work by submitting a centre authentication form (CCS160) for each internally assessed component. This should be sent to the moderator at the same time as the marks.

Internal standardisation

Centres must carry out internal standardisation to ensure that marks awarded by different teachers are accurate and consistent across all learners entered for the component from that centre.

For A Level Art and Design, centres should internally standardise across all specialisms, as well as across teaching groups within a specialism, to ensure a consistent understanding and application of the common marking criteria.

Moderation

The purpose of moderation is to bring the marking of internally-assessed components in all participating centres to an agreed standard. This is achieved by checking samples of each centre's marking of learners' work. A separate sample will be required for each component of each specialism entered.

Following internal standardisation, centres submit marks to OCR and the moderator.

Once marks have been submitted to OCR and your moderator, centres will receive a moderation sample request. Samples will include work from across the range of attainment of the learners' work. A separate sample will be required for each component of each specialism entered.

The moderation for A Level in Art and Design will be conducted by a visit to your centre.

Your moderator will contact you to make arrangements for the visit and instruct you on the work to be displayed.

Centres will receive the outcome of moderation when the provisional results are issued. This will include:

Moderation Adjustments Report – listing any scaling that has been applied to internally-assessed components.

Moderator Report to Centres – a brief report by the moderator on the internal assessment of learners' work per component.

4d. Results and certificates

Grade scale

A level qualifications are graded on the scale: A*, A, B, C, D, E, where A* is the highest. Learners who fail to reach the minimum

standard for E will be Unclassified (U). Only subjects in which grades A* to E are attained will be recorded on certificates.

Results

Results are released to centres and learners for information and to allow any queries to be resolved before certificates are issued.

Centres will have access to the following results information for each learner:

- the grade for the qualification
- the raw mark for each component
- the total weighted mark for the qualification.

The following supporting information will be available:

- raw mark grade boundaries for each component
- weighted mark grade boundaries for each qualification(s).

Until certificates are issued, results are deemed to be provisional and may be subject to amendment. A learner's final results will be recorded on an OCR certificate.

The qualification titles will be shown on the certificate as:

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art, Craft and Design'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Fine Art'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Graphic Communication'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Photography'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Textile Design'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Three-Dimensional Design'

'OCR Level 3 Advanced GCE in Art and Design: Critical and Contextual Studies'.

4e. Post-results services

A number of post-results services are available:

- **Enquiries about results** – If you are not happy with the outcome of a learner's results, centres may submit an enquiry about results.

- **Missing and incomplete results** – This service should be used if an individual subject result for a learner is missing, or the learner has been omitted entirely from the results supplied.

4f. Malpractice

Any breach of the regulations for the conduct of examinations and coursework may constitute malpractice (which includes maladministration) and must be reported to OCR as soon as it is detected. Detailed

information on malpractice can be found in the JCQ publication *Suspected Malpractice in Examinations and Assessments: Policies and Procedures*.

5 Appendices

5a. Grade descriptors

To be confirmed by Ofqual.

5b. Overlap with other qualifications

There is no significant overlap between the content of these specifications and that for other GCE specifications. There is however, a degree of overlap between the content of these specifications and those for Advanced GCE Applied Art and Design, particularly if an

applied approach to these specifications is adopted. There is a small degree of overlap with GCE Design and Technology which again is more significant if an applied approach is taken in the Art and Design specifications.